

period. He began his musical career as a choirboy at Avila Cathedral. After his voice broke, he went to Rome, where he spent about 20 years (c. 1565–c. 1586). He was ordained a priest in 1575 and held various church appointments as well as publishing several collections of his musical works. After his return to Spain, he served as chaplain to Philip II's sister, the dowager empress Maria, who lived at the Convent of the Descalzas Reales in Madrid. Following her death in 1603, Victoria stayed at the convent as organist until his own death. All his music is religious. It is remarkable for its emotional intensity, with a mystical flavor that is thought to be quintessentially Spanish. He has been seen as a musical counterpart to El Greco, his great contemporary among Spanish painters.

KEY WORKS: Officium Hebdomadae Sanctae (Music for Holy Week), 1585; Veni, Sancte Spiritus (Come, Holy Spirit), 1600; Officium defunctorum (Office [rite] of the Dead), 1605